

Luca Bertolani Azeredo

Historian of political violence · PhD in Global History and Governance

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Research interests

Political violence, paramilitarism and armed citizenship in Ireland, 1909–1916; the state and private management of violence and policing; youth organisations and the pedagogy of militarism; Italian migration to Ireland from the nineteenth century to the present; comparative and global approaches to social protest and collective violence.

Current research project

Before the Revolution: Armed Citizenship and Civil Militarism in Modern Ireland. Scholarship on the decade before 1916 has concentrated almost entirely on explicitly political, insurgent or illegal armed organisations, reading violence through the lenses of revolution, sectarian conflict and state repression. This project shifts attention to the cultural, legal and social substratum that made armed practices intelligible, legitimate and socially embedded before they became associated with insurgency: the civilian rifle clubs, shooting associations, cadet formations and voluntary training organisations active in Ireland between 1900 and 1925 — neither clandestine militias nor purely recreational bodies, but organisations embedded in schools, sporting cultures, patriotic associations and projects of physical and moral improvement. The distinction between legitimate and illegitimate armed organisation was rarely fixed in advance: it was politically negotiated, legally contested and administratively redefined in response to shifting anxieties about loyalty, citizenship, public order and national security. The project combines archival research, legislative history, social and cultural history, prosopography and digital methods, and sets the Irish case alongside the civil-militarism movements studied for Britain, France, Germany, Switzerland and Italy.

Education

- 2021–2026** **PhD in Global History and Governance (Doctor Europaeus)**, Scuola Superiore Meridionale, Naples
Dissertation: «**There are illegalities that are not crimes**». An investigation into political violence and paramilitary bodies in Ireland before the Great War
Supervisor: Teodoro Tagliaferri
External reviewers: Martin O'Donoghue (Max Planck Institute for Legal History and Legal Theory), Edward Burke (University College Dublin)
Jury: Teodoro Tagliaferri, Matteo Millan (Padova), Eugenio F. Biagini (Cambridge)
Defended 9 February 2026, excellent with honours.
- 2024** **Visiting Research Fellow**, Trinity College Dublin
April – October 2024.
- 2023** **Visiting Student**, University College Cork
May – October 2023.
Supervisor: John Borgonovo
- 2022–2023** **Visiting Student**, Queen's University Belfast
September 2022 – February 2023.
Supervisors: Richard English, Fearghal McGarry
- 2017–2020** **MA in Historical Sciences**, University of Padua
110 cum laude, first class honours.
Dissertation: **The Irish Labour Party. From Its Origins to 1938**
Supervisors: Matteo Millan, Diarmaid Ferriter
- 2021** **Teaching qualification credits (24 CFU)**, University of Padua
Completed July 2021.

2019 Erasmus+, University College Dublin
January – May 2019.

2013-2017 BA in History, Alma Mater Studiorum – University of Bologna
101/110.
Supervisor: Alberto De Bernardi

Publications

Book chapters — forthcoming

2026 **Cittadini virili, armati, e patriottici? Il caso degli Young Citizen Volunteers, Belfast 1912-16**, in Matteo Millan, Marco Maria Aterrano, Enrico Acciai (a cura di), *Percezioni e pratiche di (in)sicurezza in Italia*, Viella.

2026 **'There are things stronger than Parliamentary majorities'. For a political use of violence in Ireland, 1909-1916**, in Karina Bénazech Wendling, Vanessa Boullet, Pauline Collombier, Tim Heron (eds), *Radicalism, Radicalisation and de-Radicalization in Ireland from 1798 to the Present Day*, Éditions de l'Université de Lorraine.

Book chapters

2024 **Il manuale del giovane terrorista. Na Fianna Éireann e la nascita del paramilitarismo irlandese**, in Generoso Cefalo e Riccardo Mardegan (a cura di), *Con quale autorità? La narrazione storica come strumento di (de)legittimazione*, Edizioni dell'Orso, Alessandria, pp. 85-92. www.ediorso.it/con-quale-autorita.html

2024 **Manly Physique, Attractive Uniforms and Drill Manoeuvres**, in Maria Gaviña-Costero, Dina Pedro, Dónall Mac Cathmhaoill (eds), *'Lost, Unhappy and at Home': The Impact of Violence on Irish Culture. Volume II: Socio-Cultural Aspects*, Peter Lang, Oxford, pp. 15-30. www.peterlang.com/document/1487257

2024 **The Irish Labour Party 1922-32: A Decade of Opposition**, in Sarah-Anne Buckle, Olivier Coquelin, Francis Devine (eds), *Retreat From Revolution. Irish Working Class Politics in the 1920s*, Umiskin Press, Dublin. umiskinpress.wordpress.com/retreat-from-revolution/

2024 **Italian Labour & Unions in the '70s. A Decade of Troubles**, in Jack McGinley, Noel Ward (eds), *Visions of Labour and Class in Ireland and Europe. Irish Labour History Society 2nd International Conference*, Umiskin Press, Dublin. umiskinpress.wordpress.com/conference-proceedings/

Book reviews

2026 **Review of New Perspectives on Conflict and Ireland in the Nineteenth Century**, ed. Paul Huddie, Cathal Billings and Arlene Crampsie, *Études irlandaises*, vol. 51, no. 1, 2026, pp. 161-162. doi: 10.4000/169ix

2026 **Review of The Science of the Child in Liberal Italy**, by Luisa Tasca, *Journal of the History of Childhood and Youth*, vol. 19, no. 1, Winter 2026, pp. 76-77. doi: 10.1353/hcy.2026.a979016

2025 **Review of Conflict, Diaspora, and Empire: Irish Nationalism in Britain, 1912-1922**, by Darragh Gannon, *Irish Studies Review*, vol. 33, no. 3, pp. 440-442. doi: 10.1080/09670882.2025.2535780

2024 **Review of Roscommon: The Irish Revolution, 1912-23**, by John Burke, *Irish Studies Review*, vol. 32, no. 2, pp. 312-313. doi: 10.1080/09670882.2024.2340153

2024 **Review of The Camp Fire Girls. Gender, Race, and American Girlhood, 1910-1980**, by Jennifer Helgren, *Journal of the History of Childhood and Youth*, vol. 17, no. 2, Spring 2024, pp. 310-312. doi: 10.1353/hcy.2024.a926875

Blog articles

2020 **Come (non) si racconta una pandemia. La Spagnola nelle pagine del «Corriere della Sera»**, *Amici di Passato e Presente*, 15 giugno 2020. amicidipassatoepresente.wordpress.com/2020/06/15/come-non-si-racconta-una-pandemia-la-spagnola-nelle-pagine-del-corriere-della-sera-luca-bertolani-azeredo/

Talks (26)

INVITED TALKS (3)

23 April 2026 **The Pedagogy of Violence: Youth, Discipline, and Paramilitary Culture in Early 20th Century Ireland.** *Comparative Irish Studies from Ancient Times to the Present*, Jagiellonian University, Kraków.

17 November 2025 **The Enniskillen Horse: Illegality, Legitimacy and the Birth of Irish Paramilitarism.** *Irish Studies Seminars*, Autumn 2025, Queen's University Belfast.

14 September 2023 **Italian Labour & Unions in the '70s – a Decade of Troubles.** Irish Labour History Society 2nd International Conference, Liberty Hall, Dublin.

WORKSHOPS (12)

19 June 2026 **“Un poco di gelato, if I may”. A New History of Italian Immigration to Ireland (1880s-1926).** Association for the Study of Modern Italy, Postgraduate Summer School 2026, Department of Criminology, Cambridge.

28 November 2025 **“I Fought the Law, and I Won”. The United Kingdom and the Crisis of Paramilitarism, 1900-1916.** Engaged Citizens. Seminar PRIN 2022, University of Naples Federico II.

19 September 2025 **“Rebels under the Union Jack”. Reassessing Loyalist Radicalisation in the Home Rule Crisis.** 7th EFACIS International Postgraduate Conference, Charles University, Prague.

17 June 2025 **«There are illegalities that are not crimes». An Investigation into Political Violence and Paramilitary Bodies in Ireland before the Great War.** PhD Workshop 2024-25, discussant Brian Hughes, Scuola Superiore Meridionale, Naples.

10 December 2024 **Shaping the Youth of Conflict: Religious Divides and the Foundations of Irish Paramilitary Organizations.** Religion, Division and Development in Ireland. 3rd CEPH Irish Research Initiative Workshop, Online.

6 December 2024 **Cittadini virili, armati, e patriottici? Il caso degli Young Citizen Volunteers, Belfast 1912-16.** Percezioni e pratiche di (in)sicurezza in Italia. PRIN 2022, University of Rome Tor Vergata.

17 April 2024 **“There are things stronger than Parliamentary majorities”: For a Political Use of Violence in Ireland, 1909-1916.** Radicalism, Radicalisation, and Deradicalisation in Ireland, Université de Lorraine, Nancy.

2 April 2024 **«There are illegalities that are not crimes». An Investigation into Political Violence and Paramilitary Bodies in Ireland before the Great War.** Doctoral Workshop, discussants Richard English e Daniel Joseph Macarthur-Seal, Scuola Superiore Meridionale, Naples.

23 September 2023 **The Children of the Empire. Youth Organisations in British Ireland between Imperialism and Anti-Colonialism, 1909-1916.** 6th EFACIS International Postgraduate Conference, Charles University, Prague.

30 May 2023 **Manly Physique, Attractive Uniforms, and Drill Manoeuvres: Kids and Boys Playing with War in Pre-War Ireland.** Gender and Sexuality History Workshop, Easter 2023, University of Cambridge.

21 March 2023 **“There are illegalities that are not crimes”. An Investigation into Political Violence and Paramilitary Bodies in Ireland before the Great War.** Global History and Governance – Research Workshop 2022-2023, Scuola Superiore Meridionale, Naples.

8 November 2018 **1918 – L'influenza Spagnola. Riflessione e discussione a 100 anni dalla più grande epidemia della storia.** Simposio Permanente della Storia, University of Padua.

CONFERENCES (11)

26 September 2026 **‘I’m an Alien, I’m a Legal Alien. I’m an Italianman in Old Cork’: The Italian Community in Ireland 1880s-1926.** ACIS Midwest and South Regions Meetings, University of Notre Dame, IN.

27 March 2026 **Migrants in a Divided Land: Italian Communities and the Making of Modern Ireland.** Colloque SOFEIR “Irish Exceptionalism”, Université de Strasbourg.

12 September 2025 **La Dolce Vita? Story of an Italian Ice-Cream Parlour in Enniskillen.** 35th Irish Conference of Historians, Maynooth University.

8 May 2025 **Framing Military Resistance: The Press and the Irish Home Rule Crisis.** EFACIS Conference 2025, Åbo / Turku.

20 June 2024 **“No Man shall ride armed within the Realm”: The Enniskillen Horse and the Irish Home Rule Crisis.** ACIS MIC 2024 Conference, Mary Immaculate College, Limerick.

5 June 2024 **“It may be tomfoolery – but is it legal?” The Enniskillen Horse and the Irish Home Rule Crisis (1912-14).** Galway Conference of Irish Studies 2024: Slow Violence X Irish Studies, University of Galway.

24 August 2023 **Na Fianna Éireann and the Young Citizen Volunteers.** EFACIS Conference 2023, Queen’s University Belfast.

31 May 2023 **The Balloon and the Bullet. Children and Young People in Irish Early Paramilitarism.** 21st International AEDEI Conference, Universitat de València.

- 3 March 2023** **Manly Physique, Attractive Uniforms, and Drill Manoeuvres. Two Case Studies in Pre-War Ireland.** Irish History Students' Association 74th Annual Conference, Carlow College.
- 29 October 2022** **The Handbook of the Young Terrorist. Na Fianna Éireann and Irish Paramilitarism.** Economic and Social History Society of Ireland Conference, Maynooth University.
- 24 May 2022** **Il manuale del giovane terrorista. Na Fianna Éireann e il paramilitarismo irlandese.** Student Conference 2022 — Con quale autorità?, University of Pavia.

Conference organisation

- 2026** **Violence and Empire. From the Early 1800s to the End of the Great War**, international conference, Scuola Superiore Meridionale, Naples, 6–7 March 2026
Scientific and Organising Committee; chair of the first keynote (Tanja Bühler). Keynote speakers: Tanja Bühler, Georgina Sinclair.

Grants and awards

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| 2026 | Association for the Study of Modern Italy (ASMI) | £200 |
| 2025 | European Federation of Associations and Centres of Irish Studies (EFACIS) | €400 |
| 2025 | Irish Committee for Historical Sciences | €256 |
| 2023 | Irish Labour History Society | €110.33 |
| 2021-2025 | Fully funded doctoral scholarship, Scuola Superiore Meridionale | |

Teaching

- 2026** **The Twentieth Century Seen from Ireland**
Guest lecture, Storia del Novecento (Giovanni Focardi) — MA in Historical Sciences, University of Padua

Archival research

- 2019-2026** **Archival research**, United Kingdom and Ireland
The National Archives (London) · National Archives of Ireland · Public Record Office of Northern Ireland · National Library of Ireland · Military Archives (Dublin) · UCD Archives · Queen's University Belfast Special Collections · Linen Hall Library · Libraries NI (Enniskillen) · Fermanagh County Museum
- 2019** **Traineeship**, Centro per la storia dell'Università di Padova
June – October 2019, "Bo 2022" project. Supervisors: Andrea Martini and Remigio Pegoraro.

Digital project

- Italians in Ireland** — italians-in-ireland.github.io
A census of the Italian families who migrated to Ireland between the nineteenth and twentieth centuries: biographical records, census sources and a navigable map of settlement.

Professional memberships

Italian Association for Public History (IAPH) · European Federation of Associations and Centres of Irish Studies (EFACIS) · Irish Labour History Society (ILHS) · Società Italiana per lo Studio della Storia Contemporanea (SISSCO)

Languages and skills

Languages. Italian (native); English (C1, IELTS); French (good passive knowledge of sources). **Digital.** Zotero, Nodegoat, Obsidian, QGIS.